

Blank Slate Philadelphia-Style Ice Cream

Makes between 1 and 1½ quarts ice cream

Milk powder (2%)
20g | 3 tablespoons

Sugar (15%)
150g | ¾ cup

Cream (38%)
380g | 2 cups

Milk (40%)
400g | 2 cups

Glucose (5%)
50g | ¼ cup

Texture agent of your choice
(see below)

This recipe is a blank slate, created so you can adapt it to any flavor you like. All the recipes in this chapter are based on this formula, with adjustments made to both the ingredients and the technique. Armed with this basic recipe, you can invent any flavor of Philadelphia-style ice cream you like. I recommend it for making ice creams with bright, fresh flavors, such as herbs and flowers; teas; citrus; chocolate; alternative dairy products; and blended-in baked goods.

Combine the milk powder and sugar. Mix the milk powder and sugar ① in a small bowl.

Boil the dairy. Place the cream, milk, and glucose in a medium heavy-bottomed saucepan over medium-high heat and cook, whisking occasionally to discourage the milk from scorching, until it comes to a full rolling boil.

Add and cook the milk powder. Whisk the milk powder mixture into the pot. Reduce the heat to a low simmer and continue cooking for 2 minutes ④, whisking to prevent scorching ③.

Chill. Immediately pour the ice cream base into a shallow metal or glass bowl. Working quickly, fill a large bowl two-thirds of the way with very icy ice water. Nest the hot bowl into this ice bath, stirring occasionally until it cools down ②.

Strain. When the base is cool to the touch (50°F or below), strain it through a fine-mesh sieve. (This step is optional, but will help ensure the smoothest ice cream possible.)

Cure. Transfer the base to the refrigerator to cure for 4 hours, or preferably overnight. (This step is also optional, but the texture will be much improved with it.)

Churn. Place the base into the bowl of an ice cream maker and churn according to the manufacturer's instructions. The ice cream is ready when it thickens into the texture of soft-serve ice cream and holds its shape, typically 20 to 30 minutes.

Harden. To freeze your ice cream in the American hard-pack style, immediately transfer it to a container with an airtight lid. Press plastic wrap directly on the surface of the ice cream to prevent ice crystals from forming, cover, and store it in your freezer until it hardens completely, between 4 and 12 hours. Or, feel free to enjoy your ice cream immediately; the texture will be similar to soft-serve.

TEXTURE AGENTS

① **Best texture**
Commercial stabilizer
3g | 1 teaspoon mixed
with the sugar before it
is added to the dairy.

② **Least icy**
Guar or xanthan gum
1g | ¼ teaspoon whirled
in a blender with the ice
cream base after it is
chilled in the ice bath.

③ **Easiest to use**
Tapioca starch
5g | 2 teaspoons mixed
with 20g | 2 tablespoons
of cold milk, whisked
into the ice cream
base after it is finished
cooking.

④ **Most accessible**
Cornstarch
10g | 1 tablespoon plus
1 teaspoon, mixed with
20g | 2 tablespoons of
cold milk, whisked into
the simmering ice cream
base, and cooked for 1
more minute.

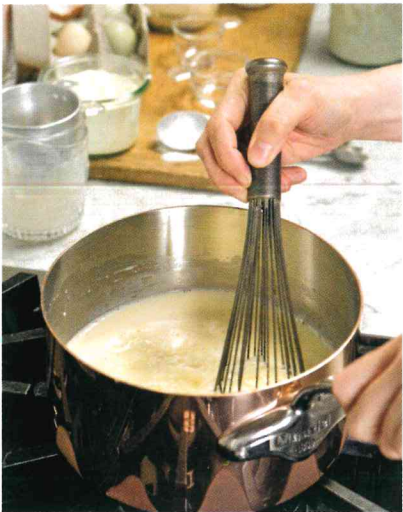


fig. 1

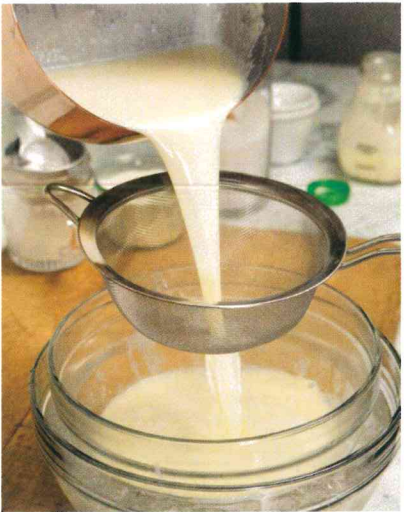


fig. 2



fig. 3

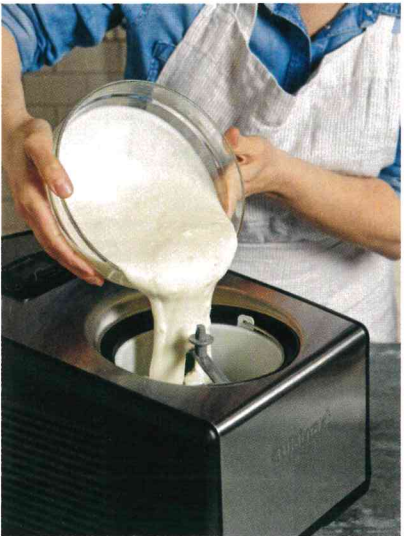


fig. 4

fig. 1: Boil the dairy.

fig. 2: Strain the ice cream base.

fig. 3: Cure the ice cream base.

fig. 4: Churn the ice cream.